

IFE 2026 — AI Tools Quick Reference (Free / API-Only)

Everything here is either free open-source software or uses free API tiers. No paid subscriptions required.

Free API Providers (No Credit Card)

PROVIDER	MODELS	FREE TIER
Groq	Llama 3, Mixtral, Gemma	30 req/min, no card needed
Google AI Studio	Gemini 2.0 Flash	1,500 req/day, no card needed
OpenRouter	200+ models (pay-per-use)	Some free models, \$1 free credit
Local (cpu lp)	Llama 3.2 1B/3B	\$0 — runs entirely offline

Entrepreneurship First Rule

"Today we learn _____. The AI helps us _____."

Never open with the tool. Open with the problem.

Week-by-Week Tool Map

WK	DAY	ACTIVITY	TOOL	SETUP	ACTIVITY	KEY PROMPT / FLOW
1	2	AI Whisperer	llm CLI	5m	25m	<code>llm -m groq "Describe X without using y"</code>
1	3	Founder's Remix	ComfyUI	10m	30m	SDXL workflow, 10 prompt iterations
1	4	Domino Effect	llm CLI	5m	25m	<code>cat notes \ llm -s "List consequences"</code>
2	1	Grumpy User	llm CLI	5m	25m	<code>llm -s "Roleplay as skeptic" --no-stream</code>
2	2	Treasure Hunt	Langflow	15m	30m	Search agent (no-cost, local models)
2	3	The Translator	llm CLI	5m	20m	<code>llm \ llm \ llm</code> (chained pipes)
2	5	Sketch-to-Magic	ComfyUI	15m	35m	IP-Adapter + SDXL, no GPU cloud needed
3	1	Spy Agency	Langflow	15m	35m	3-agent flow: Researcher > Analyst > Writer
3	2	Robot Court	ComfyUI+CLI	10m	40m	SD vs SDXL side-by-side, local comparison
3	3	Money Tree	llm CLI	5m	25m	<code>llm -m google-gemini "5 weird ways to \$1"</code>
3	5	5-Minute Bot	Langflow	15m	30m	Conditional emoji router node

WK	DAY	ACTIVITY	TOOL	SETUP	ACTIVITY	KEY PROMPT / FLOW
4	1	Time Traveler	llm CLI	5m	25m	llm -s "Write 2040 article about..."
4	2	Dragon's Hoard	llm CLI	5m	30m	llm "Burn rate: X spending Y vs Z"
4	3	Elevator Race	Langflow	15m	35m	Coach > Critic > Summarizer agents
5	1-2	Hollywood Trailer	ComfyUI	10m	60m	Consistent asset generation + CapCut

Tool Setup (Zero Cost)

llm CLI: `pip install llm`

```
llm keys set groq          # free, no credit card
llm keys set google        # free, no credit card
llm -m groq "hello"        # first prompt
llm -m gemini-2.0-flash "hi" # backup provider
```

No API key at all: `llm install llm-llama-cpp && llm -m llama-3.2-3b "hi"`

ComfyUI: Download portable from github.com/comfyanonymous/ComfyUI - Runs on CPU (slow but free) or any GPU - All models free: SDXL, SD3.5, FLUX (all open-weight) - Key workflow: Image > IP-Adapter > Prompt > Output

Langflow: `pip install langflow && python -m langflow run` - Opens at localhost:7860 — zero external dependencies - Use local models via Ollama: `ollama pull llama3.2` then connect in Langflow - Or use free API endpoints (Groq, Google) as provider nodes

Offline / No-Cost Fallbacks

SITUATION	SOLUTION
No internet	Print prompt cards. Students write prompts by hand. Facilitator runs them when connectivity returns.
No laptops	Whiteboard + sticky notes. Students roleplay the agents. "LLM" reads from pre-printed response deck.
API keys blocked	Local models via <code>llm install llm-llama-cpp</code> or ComfyUI (runs entirely offline after download).
School firewall	All tools run on localhost. No external requests needed once installed.
No GPU	ComfyUI runs on CPU. Slower (1-2 min per image) but usable for demonstrations.
Running short on time	Use CLI only. Covers 60% of activities, 30-second setup.

Session Script

1. **Hook** (2m): "Your customer won't tell you what's wrong. Let's build an AI persona that will."
2. **Entrepreneurship goal** (2m): State the business concept first.
3. **Tool intro** (1m): "We'll use llm CLI to do this — it's free, no account needed."
4. **Activity** (20-35m): Students work in teams.
5. **Debrief** (5m): What did the AI teach you about the business problem?